

What's Your Favorite Workout Split?

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 07, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/7UMCqGVZlao> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter makes the case that natural (drug-free) lifters should favor full body or higher-frequency splits over body part splits, because protein synthesis only lasts ~48 hours without steroids.

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Workout Split Preferences Compared 0:00

- Several people are polled on their preferred split in a head-to-head format
 - Upper/lower body vs. push/pull/legs → Upper/lower body wins the preference
 - Upper/lower body vs. body part split → Upper/lower body wins again
 - Upper/lower body vs. full body → Full body wins
- One respondent (Brandon Carter himself) says he has been doing full body workouts for over 10 years

The Science: Protein Synthesis & Steroid History 0:23

- Protein synthesis only lasts approximately **48 hours** after a training stimulus
 - If you train a muscle only once a week (classic body part split), you are missing out on 5 days of potential protein synthesis
 - Result: slower or reduced muscle growth for natural lifters
- Before steroids were invented, every bodybuilder used full body workouts
 - Higher training frequency was the default because it matched the natural protein synthesis window
- When steroids were introduced, the calculus changed
 - Steroids extend protein synthesis significantly — muscles can continue growing for a full week after a single session
 - This made the "crush one body part per day" approach viable and effective for enhanced athletes
- Key takeaway: if you are not using performance-enhancing drugs ("not on juice"), higher training frequency is likely superior

Which Split Is Actually Best? 0:46

- Brandon stops short of declaring full body the single best option for everyone
 - Suggests there is a place for regular (body part) splits under some circumstances
 - Upper/lower splits are also described as "cool"
 - Push/pull/legs is mentioned as another valid option
- The clip ends before a definitive ranking is completed, leaving the full conclusion unresolved